



ears passed. The questions never stopped. Neither did the hard work. Every afternoon, Zayd's mother waited outside another tuition center. Sometimes she was tired. Sometimes he was tired. Sometimes frustrated.

Sometimes he wondered if everyone else was simply born knowing things that took him weeks to understand. But each morning... he tried again.

One exam became another. Then another. Little by little... the impossible became possible. One afternoon, there was a commotion in the class. He noticed that his Advanced Mathematics teacher was handing back examination papers. All the students who received their papers looked clearly upset. Even on the best student's page, Zayd could make out a red letter. There was a sudden burst of anxious sadness inside him as he slowly waited for his turn.

As the Advanced Mathematics teacher passed him his papers, she smiled. Across the top of the page... was a single letter.

—A.